

How to Reduce Plastic Use at Home

Kitchen

- Replace plastic cling wrap with beeswax wraps or steel/glass containers with lids.
- Store leftovers in glass jars or stainless steel dabbas instead of plastic containers.
- Choose loose vegetables and fruits over pre-packaged ones wrapped in plastic film.
- Switch from plastic chopping boards and utensils to wood, bamboo, or steel alternatives.
- Buy milk, curd, and other daily items from vendors who accept reusable containers where available.

Bathroom & Personal Care

- Switch to bar soap and shampoo bars instead of bottled liquid versions.
- Use a bamboo or compostable toothbrush instead of a plastic one.
- Choose refill pouches for handwash, detergent, and cleaning liquids instead of buying a new bottle every time.
- Avoid products containing microplastics/microbeads, common in some scrubs and face washes — check the ingredient label for “polyethylene” or “polypropylene.”

Shopping

- Keep a set of reusable cloth or jute bags near the door or in your vehicle so you never need a plastic bag at checkout.
- Buy staples like rice, pulses, and grains from bulk/refill stores using your own containers.
- Choose products in glass, metal, or paper packaging over plastic when the option exists.
- Avoid single-use plastic cutlery and straws — carry a small reusable set if you eat out often.

Storage & Organizing

- Reuse glass jars from jams or pickles as storage containers instead of buying new plastic organizers.
- Repair plastic items (buckets, containers) instead of replacing them when possible.

Disposal (when plastic is unavoidable)

- Clean and dry plastic packaging before placing it in the dry-waste bin — contaminated plastic often cannot be recycled.
- Avoid multi-layered plastic (chips packets, sachets) where possible, as it is very difficult to recycle through standard municipal systems.
- Check if your city has plastic collection drives or take-back programs run by retailers or recyclers.

Impact Note

A typical Indian household generates a significant share of its dry waste as plastic packaging. Small substitutions — especially in the kitchen and bathroom — tend to have the highest and most sustained impact because they replace recurring purchases rather than one-off items.